

STATE OF NEW YORK

1556--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN ASSEMBLY

January 10, 2025

Introduced by M. of A. KELLES, COLTON, EPSTEIN, GIBBS, GLICK, JACKSON, LEE, LEVENBERG, RAGA, REYES, ROSENTHAL, SAYEGH, SEAWRIGHT, SHIMSKY, SIMON, STECK, STIRPE, TAPIA, CLARK, P. CARROLL, HEVESI, TORRES, CRUZ, NORBER, DINOWITZ, KAY, LUNSFORD -- read once and referred to the Committee on Agriculture -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the agriculture and markets law and the education law, in relation to enacting the "food safety and chemical disclosure act"

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. Short title. This act shall be known and may be cited as
2 the "food safety and chemical disclosure act".

3 § 2. The section heading of section 199-a of the agriculture and
4 markets law, as amended by chapter 797 of the laws of 1961, is amended
5 and a new subdivision 5 is added to read as follows:

6 Prohibition as to adulterated or misbranded food and certain food
7 additives and food color additives intended for human consumption.

8 5. (a) Notwithstanding any other provision of law to the contrary,
9 commencing one year after the effective date of this subdivision, it
10 shall be unlawful for any person, firm, association, or corporation to
11 manufacture, compound, brew, distill, produce, process, sell, deliver,
12 distribute, hold, offer or expose for sale any of the following
13 substances as food additives or food color additives or any food or food
14 product containing any of the following substances intended for human
15 consumption:

16 (i) FD&C Red No. 3;

17 (ii) Potassium bromate; or

18 (iii) Propylparaben.

19 (b) Notwithstanding the provisions of paragraph (a) of this subdivi-
20 sion, a store shall be permitted to sell, deliver, distribute, hold,
21 offer or expose for sale any food or food product containing any of the

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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substances listed in paragraph (a) of this subdivision until the expiration date, "best by" date, or "sell by" date printed on the packaging of the food or food product by the manufacturer or producer, but no later than three years after the effective date of this subdivision, provided, however, that:

(i) the store sells food or food products at retail and is not primarily engaged in the sale of food for consumption on the premises;

(ii) the store is independently owned and operated by a business that employs ten or fewer persons; and

(iii) the food or food product was acquired by the business.

(c) Within thirty days of the effective date of this subdivision, the commissioner shall amend the exemption list maintained pursuant to subdivision three of this section to indicate that in this state the substances prohibited in this subdivision shall not be deemed to be safe for human consumption on or after one year after the effective date of this subdivision.

§ 3. The education law is amended by adding a new section 915-a to read as follows:

§ 915-a. Prohibiting the sale of foods containing synthetic color additives. 1. No foods or beverages, including competitive foods as defined under 7 CFR 210.11(a)(2) and meals reimbursed under programs authorized by the federal Richard B. Russell National School Lunch Act (Public Law 113-79) and the federal Child Nutrition Act of 1966 (42 U.S.C. Sec. 1771 et seq.), containing any of the following substances shall be sold in any public school within the state:

a. FD&C Red No. 3

b. FD&C Red No. 40

c. FD&C Blue No. 1

d. FD&C Blue No. 2

e. FD&C Green No. 3

f. FD&C Yellow No. 5

g. FD&C Yellow No. 6

2. A school may permit the sale of foods and beverages that do not comply with subdivision one of this section if the sale of such items takes place either:

a. off and away from the premises of the school; or

b. on school premises at least one-half hour after the end of the school day.

§ 4. Section 198 of the agriculture and markets law is amended by adding a new subdivision 7-a to read as follows:

7-a. For purposes of this section, the term "generally recognized as safe substance" or "GRAS substance" means any substance added to food that is not exempted from the definition of "food additive" under subdivision seven of this section because it is generally recognized, among experts qualified by scientific training and experience to evaluate its safety, as having been adequately shown to be safe under the conditions of its intended use:

(a) either through scientific procedures using the same quantity and quality of scientific evidence as is required to obtain approval of the substance as a food additive; or

(b) for a substance used in food prior to January first, nineteen hundred fifty-eight, through experience based on common use in food.

§ 5. Subdivision 4 of section 199-a of the agriculture and markets law, as amended by chapter 671 of the laws of 1966, is amended to read as follows:

4. All data submitted to the commissioner in support of the food or color additives report under this section shall be considered confidential by the commissioner and shall not be revealed to any person other than to a person authorized by the commissioner in the performance of ~~his~~ their official duties under this article. In case of an actual controversy as to the validity of an order or decision of the commissioner respecting the test data or report in which a proceeding to review has been instituted as authorized by section two hundred two-c of this article the petition, data and report shall be transmitted by the commissioner to the clerk of the court in which the review proceeding is instituted, together with a record of the proceedings on which the commissioner based ~~his~~ the order or decision, and such transmittal shall not be construed to be a violation of confidence. Subdivisions two and three of this section shall not apply to food additives or color additives which are safe within the meaning of the federal food, drug and cosmetic act as amended.

§ 6. The agriculture and markets law is amended by adding a new section 199-g to read as follows:

§ 199-g. Reporting of GRAS substances. 1. a. Except as provided in subdivision two of this section, unless a report described in paragraph b of this subdivision has been submitted to the commissioner and such report is made available in the database described in subdivision five of section one hundred ninety-nine-b of this article, and notwithstanding any other provision of law to the contrary, it shall be unlawful for any person, firm, association, or corporation to:

(i) sell or offer or expose for sale for use in or on food, or to use in the manufacturing, compounding, brewing, distilling, producing, or processing of any food or food product, any GRAS substance or combination of GRAS substances;

(ii) make any new use of any GRAS substance or combination of GRAS substances in or on food; or

(iii) sell or offer or expose for sale any food or food product containing any GRAS substance or combination of GRAS substances.

b. The report required pursuant to paragraph a of this subdivision shall include but not be limited to the following information:

(i) Signed statements and a certification, including:

(1) the date and signature of a responsible official of the reporter or reporting organization;

(2) the name and address of the reporter or reporting organization;

(3) the name of any GRAS substances discussed in the report, using an appropriately descriptive term;

(4) intended conditions for the use of any GRAS substance discussed in the report, including the foods in which the substance will be used, the levels of such use in such foods, and the purposes for which the substance will be used, including, when appropriate, a description of any subpopulation expected to consume such GRAS substance or substances;

(5) the statutory basis for the conclusion of GRAS status;

(6) a statement that the reported substance is not subject to the premarket approval requirements of the federal food, drug, and cosmetic act based on the conclusion that the notified substance is GRAS under the conditions of its intended use;

(7) a statement that, if asked to see the data and information that are the basis for the GRAS conclusion, the reporter will agree to:

(A) make the data and information available to the commissioner; and

(B) upon the commissioner's request, both of the following procedures for making the data and information available to the commissioner:

(I) allow the commissioner to review and copy the data and information during customary business hours at the address specified for where these data and information will be available; and

(II) provide a complete copy of the data and information either in an electronic format or on paper;

(8) views as to whether any of the data and information in the GRAS report are exempt from disclosure under the freedom of information law;

(9) certifications that, to the best of the reporter's knowledge, the GRAS report is a complete, representative, and balanced submission that includes both unfavorable and favorable information known to the reporter and pertinent to the evaluation of the safety and GRAS status of the use of the substance; and

(10) the name and position or title of the person who signs the GRAS report.

(ii) The identity, method of manufacture, specifications, and physical or technical effect of the notified substance, including:

(1) scientific data and information that identifies the GRAS substance, including:

(A) examples of appropriate data and information including the chemical name, applicable registry numbers (such as a chemical abstracts service (CAS) registry number or an enzyme commission (EC) number), empirical formula, structural formula, quantitative composition, and characteristic properties; and

(B) when the source of a notified substance is a biological material, data and information sufficient to identify:

(I) the taxonomic source (e.g., genus, species) of the GRAS substance, including, as applicable, data and information at the sub-species level (e.g., variety, strain);

(II) the part of any plant or animal used as the source of the GRAS substance; and

(III) any known toxicants that could be in the source of the GRAS substance;

(2) a description of the method of manufacture of the GRAS substance in sufficient detail to evaluate the safety of the notified substance as manufactured;

(3) specifications for food-grade material; and

(4) when necessary to demonstrate safety, relevant data and information bearing on the physical or other technical effect the GRAS substance is intended to produce, including the quantity of the GRAS substance required to produce such effect.

(iii) Dietary exposure to the notified substance, including information about dietary exposure (i.e., the amount of relevant substances that consumers are likely to eat or drink as part of a total diet), including:

(1) an estimate of dietary exposure to the notified substance that includes exposure from its intended use and all sources in the diet;

(2) when applicable, an estimate of dietary exposure to any other substance that is expected to be formed in or on food because of the use of the notified substance (e.g., hydrolytic products or reaction products);

(3) when applicable, an estimate of dietary exposure to any other substance that is present with the notified substance either naturally or due to its manufacture (e.g., contaminants or by-products);

(4) sources of any food consumption data used to estimate dietary exposure, in accordance with clauses one through three of this subparagraph; and

(5) any assumptions made to estimate dietary exposure, in accordance with clauses one through three of this subparagraph.

(iv) Self-limiting levels of use in circumstances where the amount of the notified substance that can be added to human food or animal food is limited because the food containing levels of the notified substance above a particular level would become unpalatable or technologically impractical.

(v) If the statutory basis for GRAS status is through experience based on common use in food, evidence of a substantial history of consumption of the notified substance for food use by a significant number of consumers prior to January first, nineteen hundred fifty-eight.

(vi) A narrative that provides the basis for the conclusion of GRAS status, including:

(1) an explanation for why the data and information in the report provide a basis for that the notified substance is safe under the conditions of its intended use. Such explanation shall address the safety of the notified substance, considering all dietary sources and taking into account any chemically or pharmacologically related substances in such diet, and identify what specific data and information discussed in accordance with this clause are generally available and not generally available, by providing citations to the list of data and information required in subparagraph (vii) of this paragraph;

(2) an explanation of how the generally available data and information relied on to establish safety in accordance with clause one of this subparagraph provides a basis for the conclusion that the reported substance is generally recognized, among qualified experts, to be safe under the conditions of its intended use;

(3) either:

(A) data and information that are, or may appear to be, inconsistent with the conclusion of GRAS status; or

(B) a statement that the available data and information was reviewed and the reporter is not aware of any data and information that are, or may appear to be, inconsistent with the conclusion of GRAS status;

(4) if any data and information in the report is exempt from disclosure under the freedom of information law, a statement that identifies such data and information; and

(5) for non-public, safety-related data and information considered in reaching a conclusion of GRAS status, an explanation of how there could be a basis for a conclusion of GRAS status if qualified experts do not have access to such data and information.

(vii) A list of the generally available data, information, and methods the notifier cites in the GRAS notice, including:

(1) a list of all of the data and information required by subparagraph (vi) of this paragraph to provide a basis for determining that the notified substance is safe under the conditions of its intended use, as described in accordance with clause one of subparagraph (vi) of this paragraph; and

(2) identification of specific data and information listed in accordance with clause one of this subparagraph that are generally available and not generally available.

(viii) Any previous GRAS substance notices submitted to the federal food and drug administration on the reported substance and the federal food and drug administration's responses.

(ix) All relevant currently available safety information.

2. The following substances are exempt from the reporting requirements of subdivision one of this section:

1 a. Any GRAS substance for which the federal food and drug adminis-
2 tration has received a GRAS notice and issued a letter stating that the
3 federal food and drug administration has no questions regarding the
4 conclusion that the substance is generally recognized as safe under its
5 intended conditions of use;

6 b. Any substances recognized in federal regulations as prior sanc-
7 tioned or GRAS substances for use in food or food packaging;

8 c. Any food contact substance for which there is an effective premar-
9 ket notification demonstrating safety for its intended use;

10 d. Any substances subject to regulation approving its intended use for
11 food;

12 e. A food ingredient of natural biological origin that has been widely
13 consumed for its nutrient properties in the United States prior to Janu-
14 ary first, nineteen hundred fifty-eight without known detrimental
15 effects, which is subject only to conventional processing as practiced
16 prior to January first, nineteen hundred fifty-eight, and for which no
17 known safety hazard exists;

18 f. Any substance for which the federal food and drug administration
19 has received a new dietary ingredient notification and issued a letter
20 of acknowledgement without objection that the substance is safe under
21 its notification's intended conditions of use; and

22 g. Any substance determined safe to be added to foods by the commis-
23 sioner through rulemaking.

24 3. Any person may file a report to the commissioner under this
25 section.

26 4. A small business, defined as a business that is independently owned
27 and operated and employs ten or fewer persons, shall be exempt from the
28 requirements of this section.

29 5. Data establishing the general recognition of safety shall be based
30 on publicly available information and shall not be based on trade
31 secrets.

32 § 7. Section 199-b of the agriculture and markets law is amended by
33 adding a new subdivision 5 to read as follows:

34 5. The commissioner:

35 a. shall make reports submitted pursuant to section one hundred nine-
36 ty-nine-g of this article available to the public in a database on its
37 website. The database shall:

38 (i) be searchable by members of the public;

39 (ii) enable consumers to download and print displayed information; and

40 (iii) accommodate reasonably anticipated and actual public use.

41 b. shall redact from the public report any information that has been
42 designated by the submitter as a trade secret, provided, however, that
43 data establishing the general recognition of safety shall not be redact-
44 ed;

45 c. shall update the database with any new information that the commis-
46 sioner receives relating to the safety of the GRAS substance;

47 d. may refuse to list a GRAS substance if the commissioner determines
48 the report does not contain the information required by section one
49 hundred ninety-nine-g of this article;

50 e. shall provide an interim progress report concerning efforts to
51 develop and implement the database system required by this subdivision,
52 which shall include:

53 (i) a projected completion date;

54 (ii) a description of obstacles to development and implementation of
55 the database system; and

1 (iii) an estimate of the costs to complete the implementation of the
2 database system; and
3 f. may charge a fee to the reporter of a GRAS substance in order to
4 recover the costs incurred in listing such GRAS substance and maintain-
5 ing the database.

6 § 8. The second undesignated paragraph of section 202-c of the agri-
7 culture and markets law, as amended by chapter 671 of the laws of 1966,
8 is amended to read as follows:

9 The commissioner may institute such action at law or in equity as may
10 appear necessary to enforce compliance with sections one hundred nine-
11 ty-nine-a, one hundred ninety-nine-g, two hundred and two hundred one of
12 this article, and any rule or order respecting a GRAS substance, food
13 additive, or color additive promulgated pursuant to sections one hundred
14 ninety-nine-b and two hundred fourteen-b of this article and, in addi-
15 tion to any other remedy under this chapter or otherwise, may apply for
16 relief by injunction to protect the public interest without being
17 compelled to allege or prove that an adequate remedy at law does not
18 exist. In an action instituted by the commissioner to enforce compliance
19 with said sections one hundred ninety-nine-a, two hundred and two
20 hundred one the commissioner shall not be required to prove that the
21 food, food additive or color additive mentioned in the complaint is
22 unsafe and the claim or defense of the defendant as to its safety shall
23 be immaterial, provided, however, that the recognition by the federal
24 food and drug administration of a food additive or color additive as
25 safe may be alleged as a proper defense.

26 § 9. This act shall take effect on the one hundred eightieth day after
27 it shall have become a law.